

APPENDIX: Don't Budge! The Reputational Cost of Political Compromises

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Appendix C. Additional Experiment: Testing Stimulus Material

Figure OA.1 below shows that the data is unbalanced for the variable **Digital Literacy**. As described in the Pre-Analysis Plan (p.10), we will add this co-variates to the analyses as controls.

Figure OA.1: Balance Test

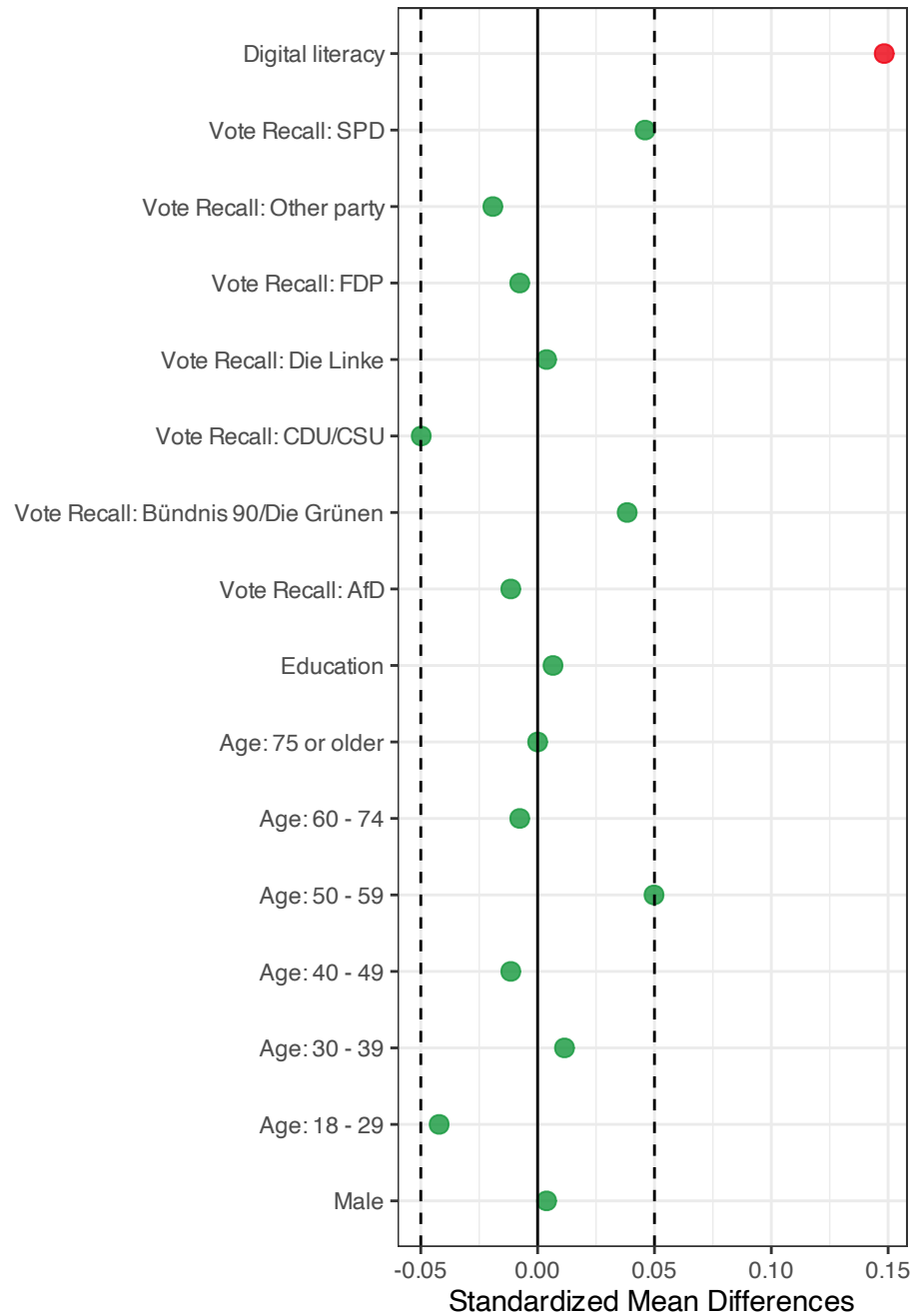


Figure OA.2: Predicting Treatment Differences

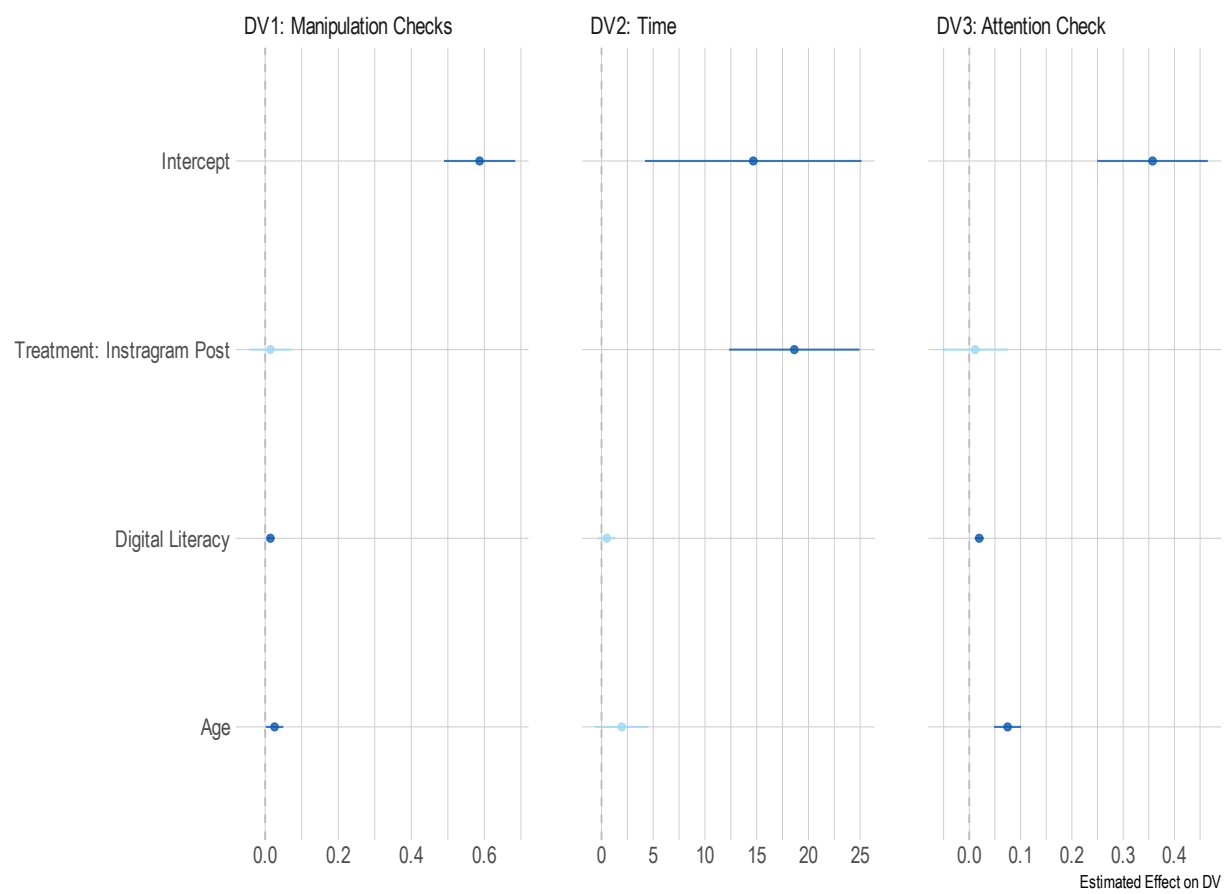
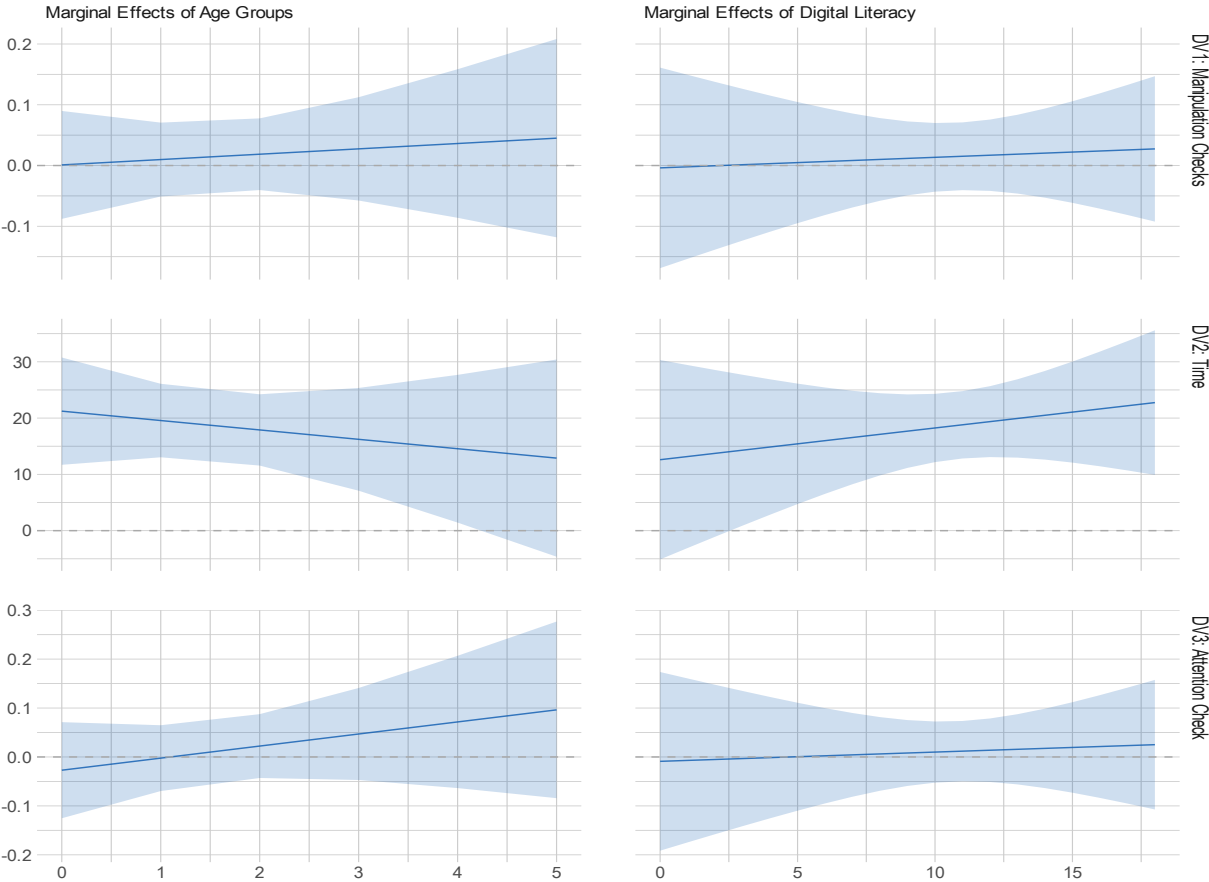
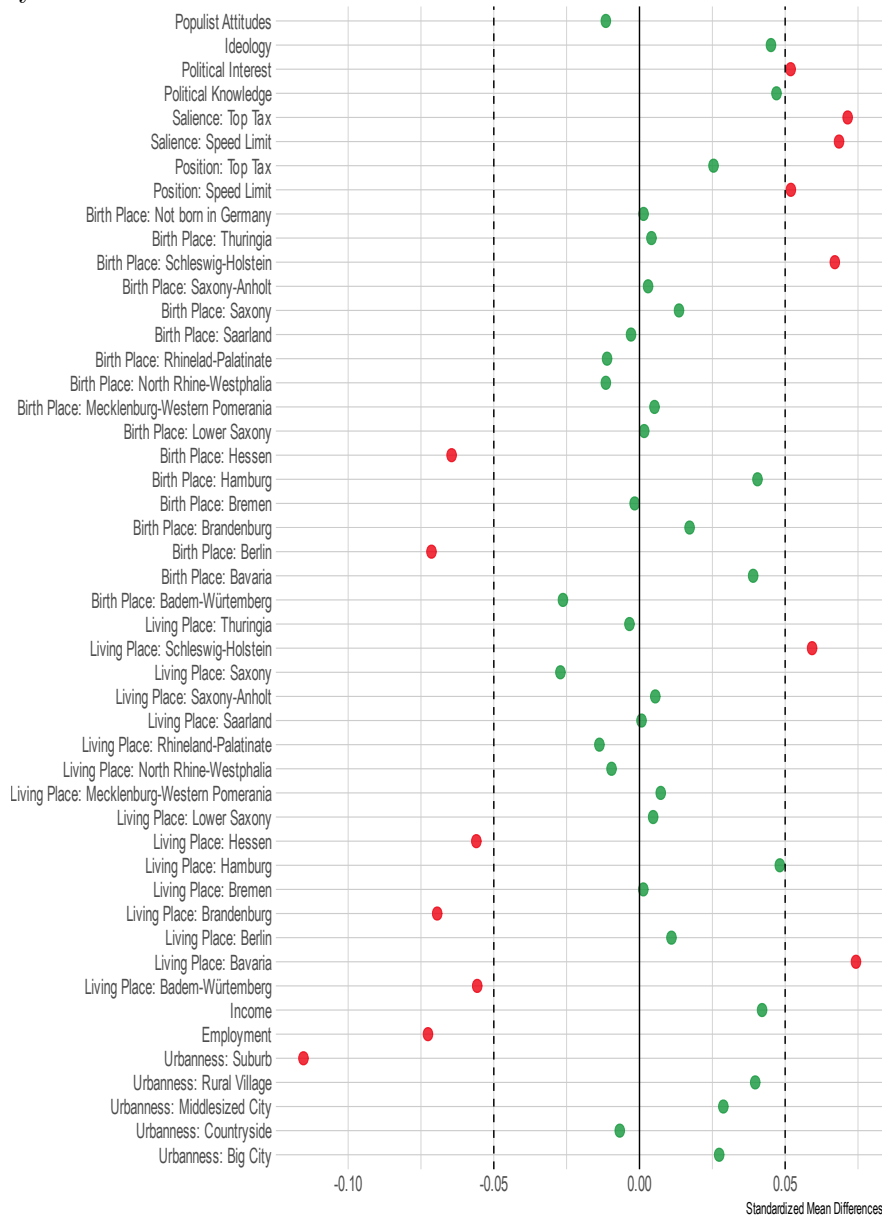


Figure OA.3: Heterogeneous Treatment Effects



Appendix E. Balance Checks

We have conducted a balance test based on demographics (age, gender, education, geographical region, level of urbanness, employment, and income), vote choice in the 2021 parliamentary elections, ideological self-placement, political knowledge, political interest, party identity strength, and positions on and salience of the three issues, using the `cobalt` R package (Greifer 2021). The figure below shows that the data is unbalanced for the variables: **Education, Income, Employment, Urbaness, Living Place, Birth Place, Age, Political Knowledge, Political Interest, and Ideology**. As described in the [Pre-Analysis Plan \(p.10\)](#), we have added these co-variates to the analyses as controls.

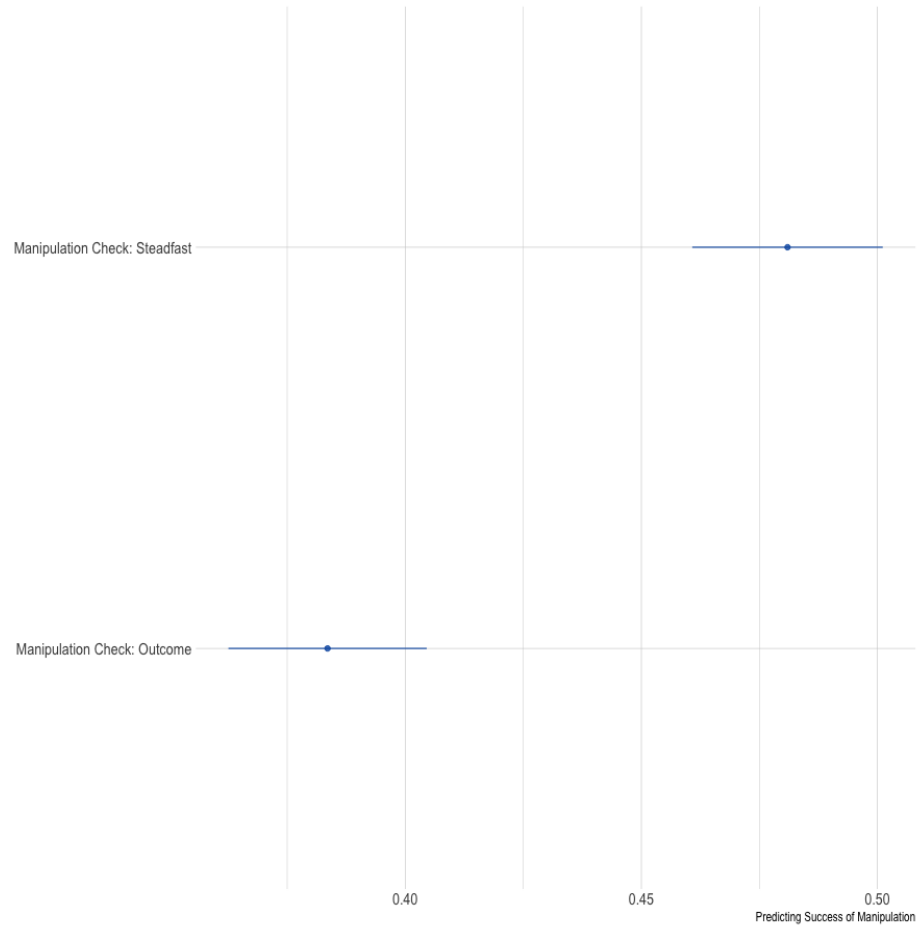


Appendix F. Manipulation Checks

Effectiveness of Manipulation

Figure OA.4 shows that both manipulations in the experiment are successful: The significant effects of both manipulations indicate that those in the experimental group reported to have seen the manipulated conditions.

Figure OA.4: Effect of Treatment on Manipulations Checks



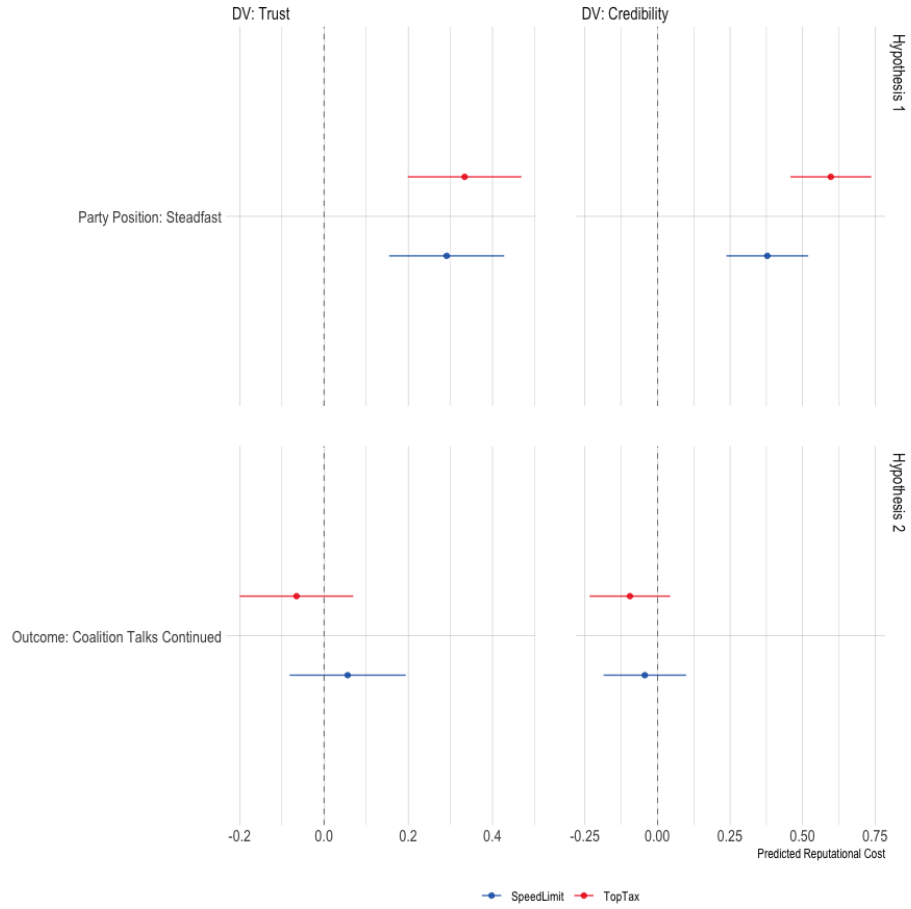
H1 and H2 for those passing the Manipulation Checks

Looking at those respondents who have correctly filled in the manipulation checks, Figure OA.5 shows that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 2) do not change.

H3 for those passing the Manipulation Checks

Looking at those respondents who have correctly filled in the manipulation checks, Figure ?? shows that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 3) do not change.

Figure OA.5: Predicted Reputational Cost



H4 for those passing the Manipulation Checks

Looking at those respondents who have correctly filled in the manipulation checks, Figure OA.7 shows that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 4) do not change.

H5 for those passing the Manipulation Checks

Looking at those respondents who have correctly filled in the manipulation checks, Figure OA.8 shows that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 5) do not change.

Figure OA.6: Predicted Reputational Cost

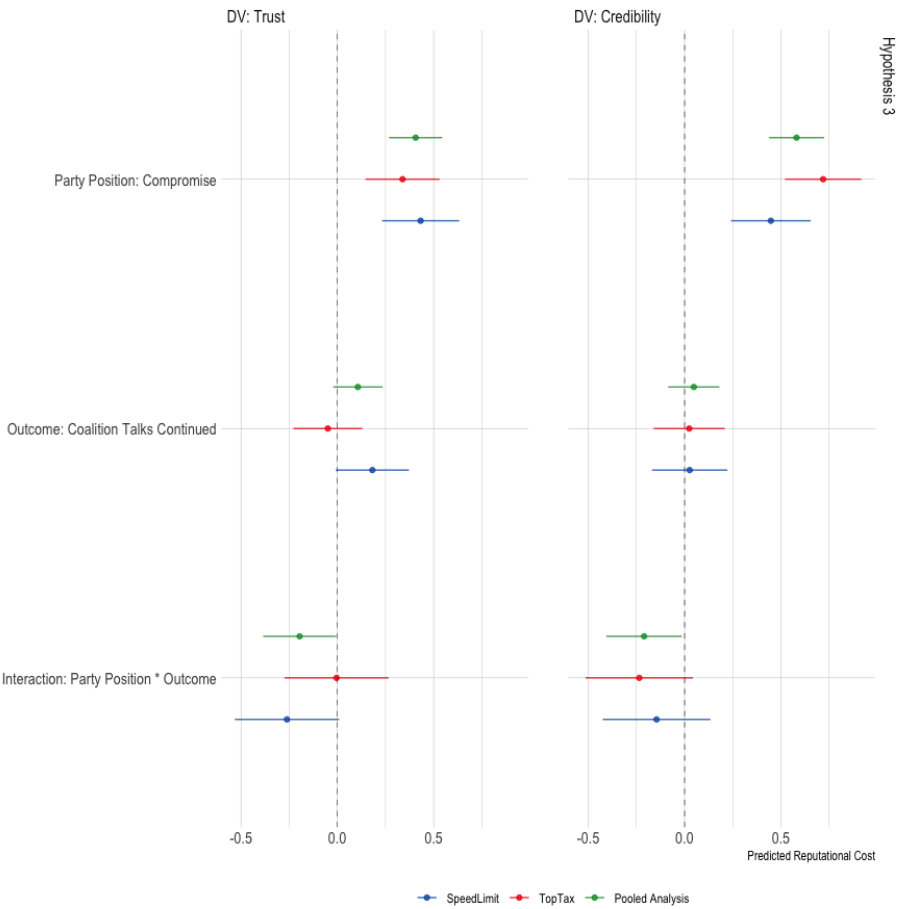


Figure OA.7: Heterogeneous Treatment Effect: Principledness

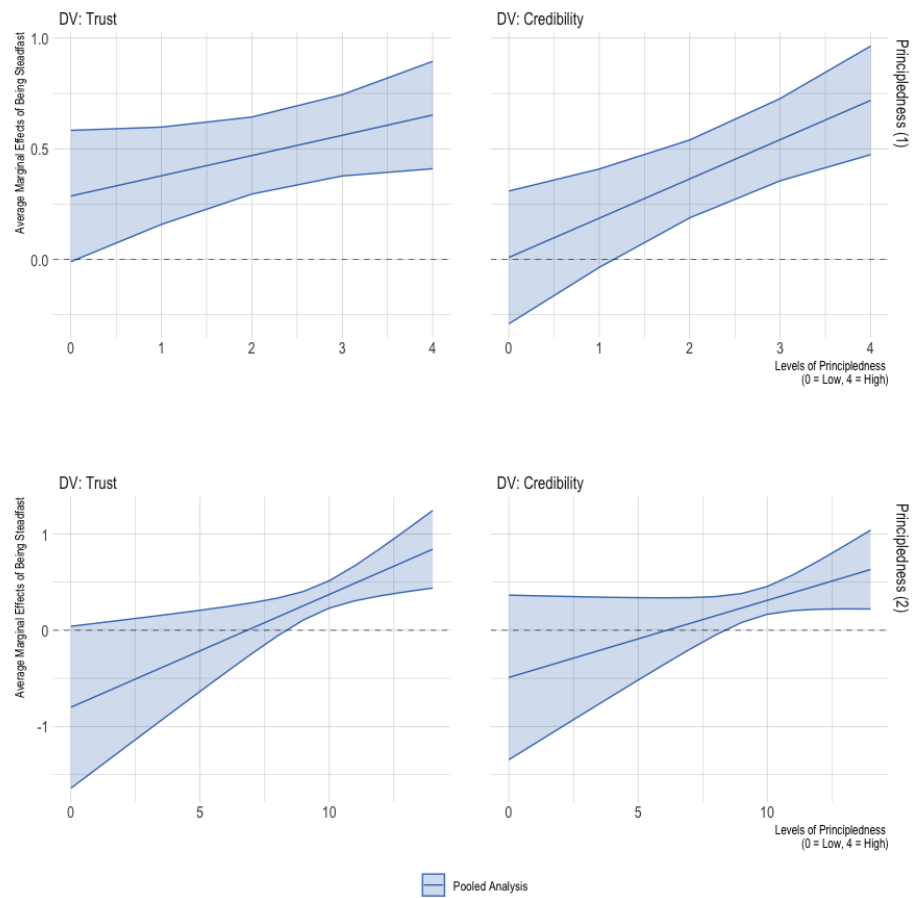
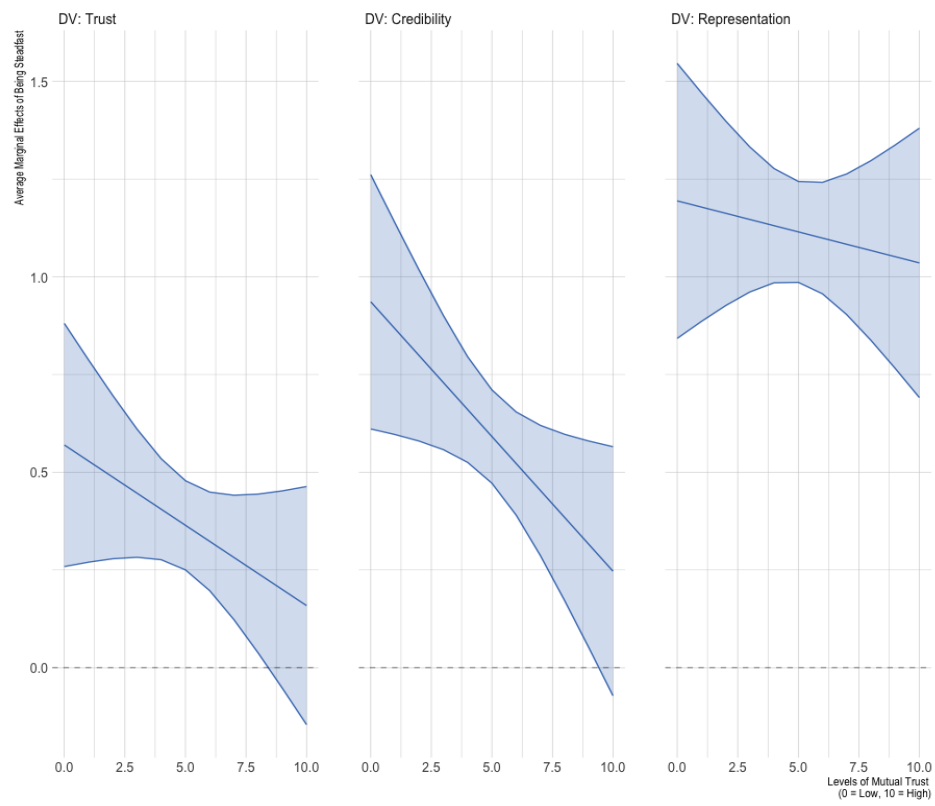


Figure OA.8: Heterogeneous Treatment Effect: Social Trust

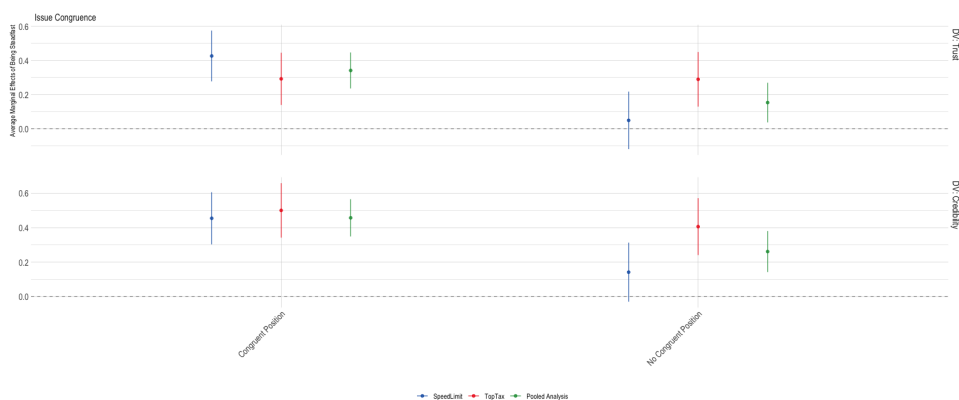


Appendix I. Explorative Analysis: Heterogeneous treatments for H1

HT: Issue congruence

Figure OA.9 visualizes the heterogeneous effect of issue congruence. Looking at the issue of speed limits, we see that respondents who hold a congruent issue position with the party, they value staying steadfast less than those who hold an incongruent issue position. We however observe the complete opposite for the issue top tax, but the difference however is insignificant. This means that we cannot conclude a uniform moderating effect of issue congruence on the relationship between parties' reputation and striking a compromise.

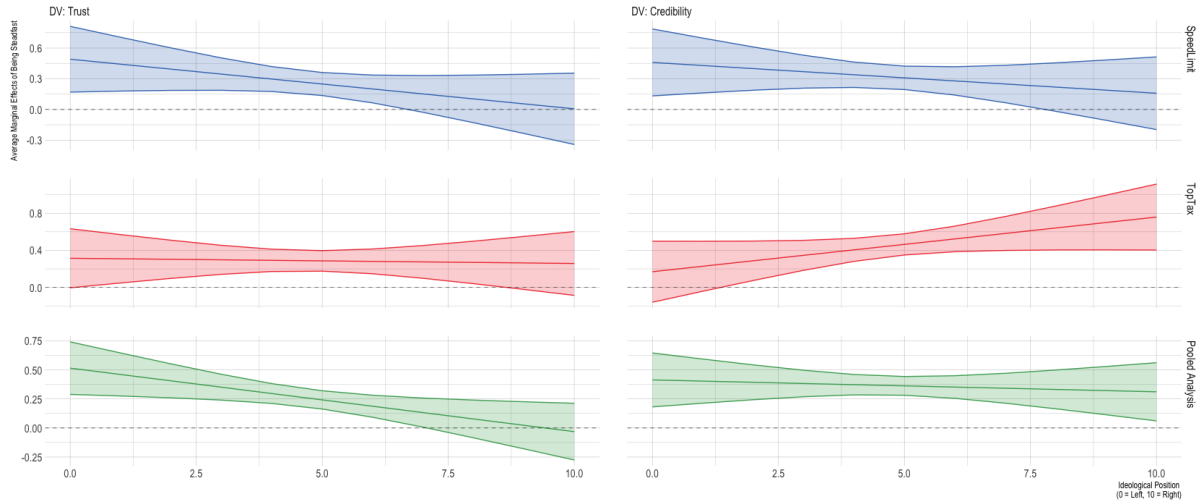
Figure OA.9: Heterogenous Treatment Issue Congruence



HT: Ideological Position

Figure OA.10 demonstrates that the respondents with a left-leaning ideological orientation prefer parties to stay steadfast on the issue of top tax, while right-leaning voters prefer a political compromise. There is however no significant difference between the left and the right when it comes to the issue of speed limit. This indicates that for issues that align with the dimension, you like your party to stick to their ideological commitment.

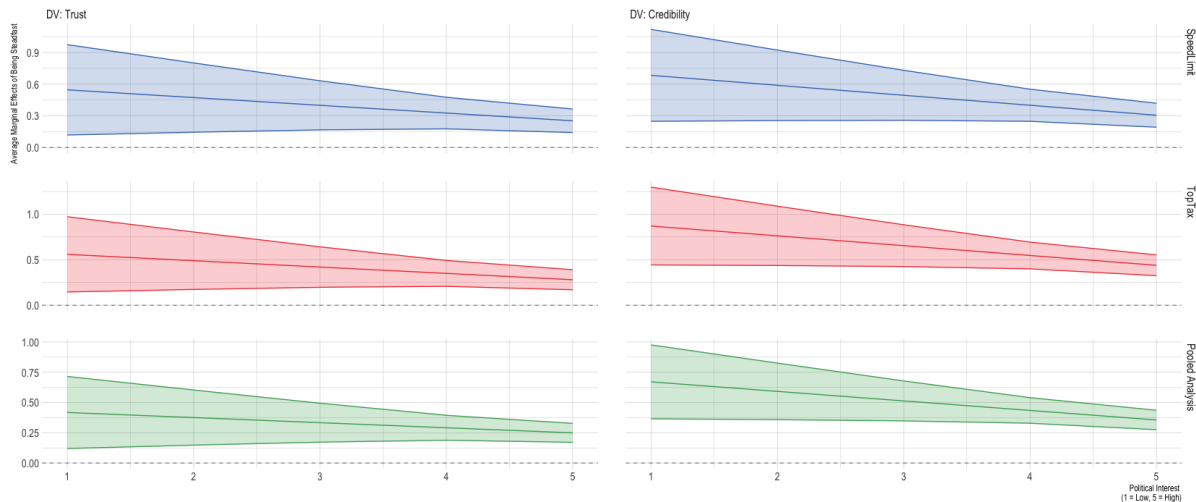
Figure OA.10: Heterogenous Treatment Ideological Position



HT: Political Interest

Figure ?? demonstrates that the more political interest a respondent has, the less likely the respondent values the party stating steadfast. This indicates that people with high levels of political interest, they prefer the party to seek a political compromise. This could be an indication of understanding politics – if a party gives in on something, it might be that they later get something in return.

Figure OA.11: Heterogenous Treatment Political Interest

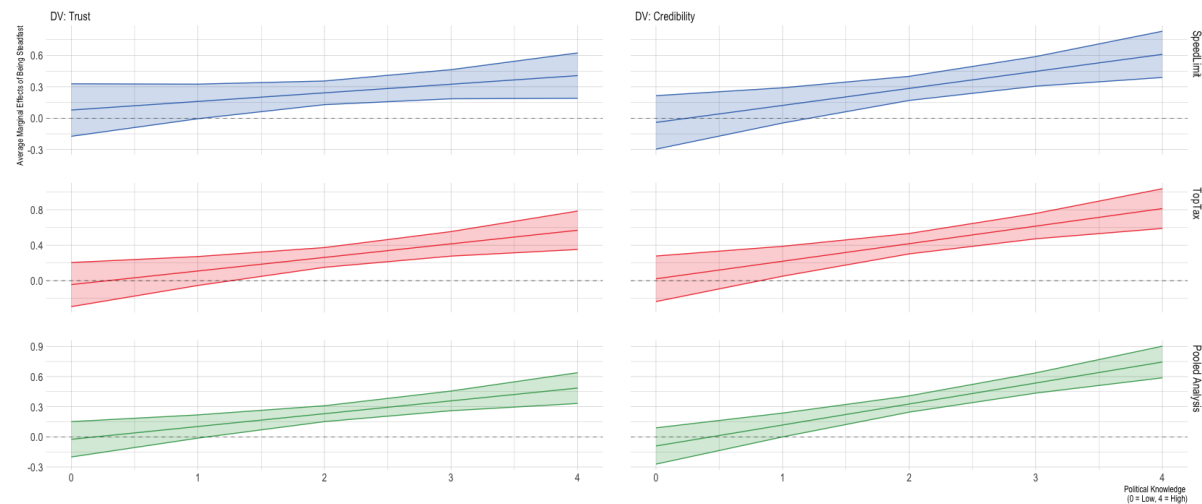


HT: Political Knowledge

Figure ?? demonstrates, similar to Political Interest, that the more political knowledge a respondent has, the less likely the respondent values the party stating steadfast. This indicates that people

with high levels of political knowledge, they prefer the party to seek a political compromise.

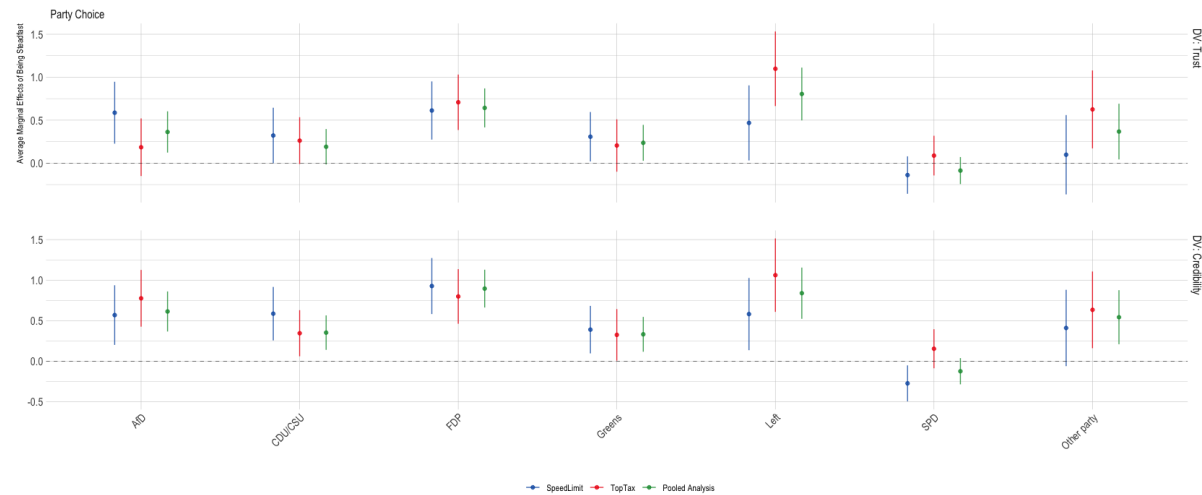
Figure OA.12: Heterogenous Treatment Political Knowledge



HT:Party Choice

The effect of this analysis is elaborated on in the main text.

Figure OA.13: Heterogenous Treatment Party Choice

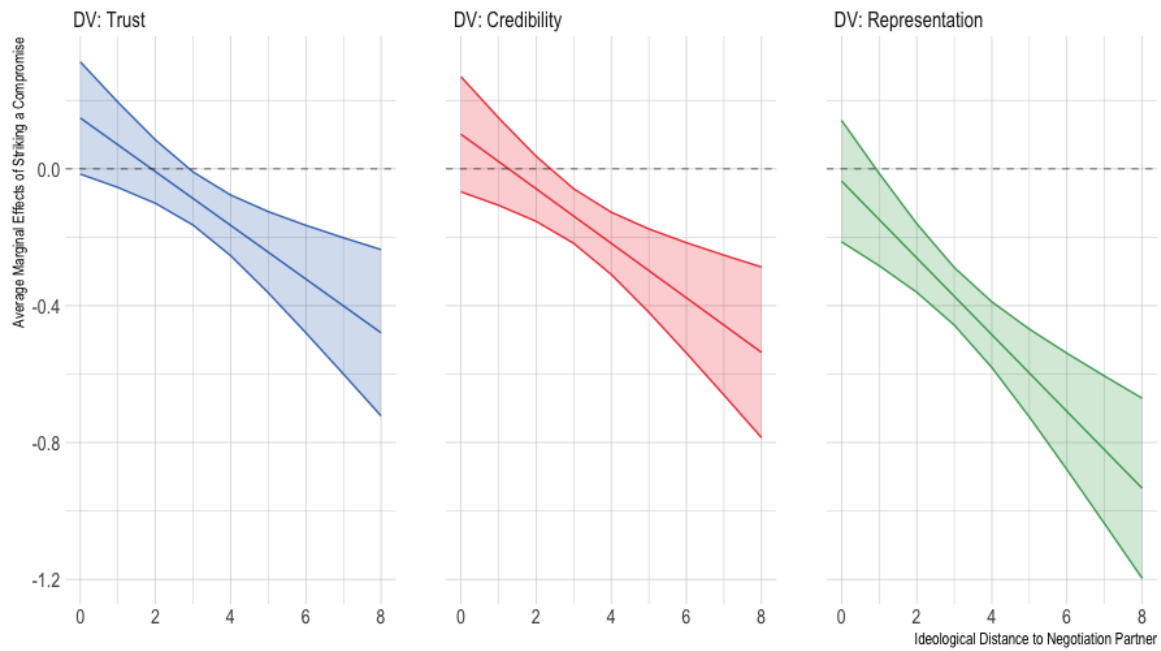


Appendix J. Explorative Analysis: Heterogeneous treatments for H2

HT: Ideological Distance towards Coalition Partner

Figure OA.14 demonstrates that the respondents who are further away from the coalition partner evaluate their party more negative when they continue the coalition talks than those respondents that are closer to the coalition partner.

Figure OA.14: Heterogenous Treatment Ideological Distance to Coalition Partner

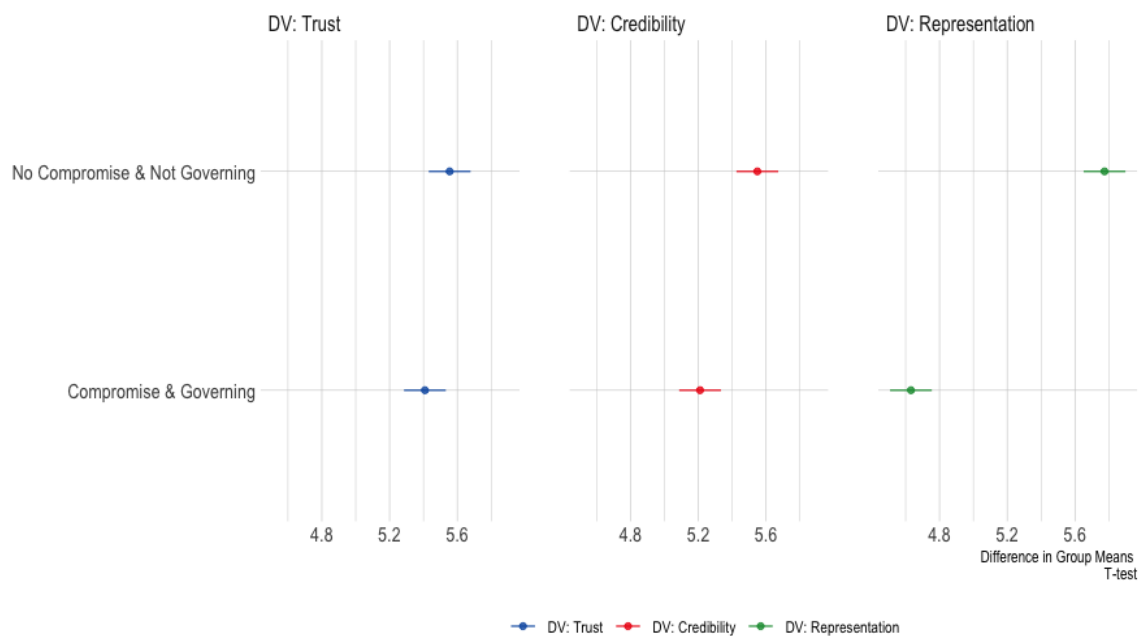


Appendix K. Additional Robustness Analyses Experimental Study

Comparing No Government & No Compromise to Government & Compromise

Figure OA.15 demonstrates that both groups, either seeing no government and no compromise or government and compromise, evaluate the party negatively. Indicating that either an office-seeking strategy is never rewarded by voters, maybe because of their optimism bias.

Figure OA.15: Heterogenous Treatment Ideological Distance to Coalition Partner

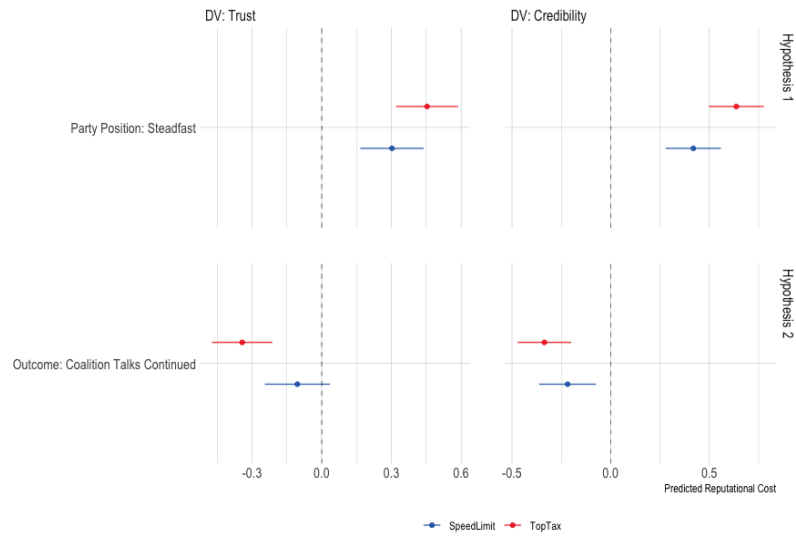


Knowledge of Parties Negotiation

Hypothesis 1 & 2

Looking at those respondents who know which parties are negotiating for the 2021 coalition, Figure OA.22 shows that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 2) do not change.

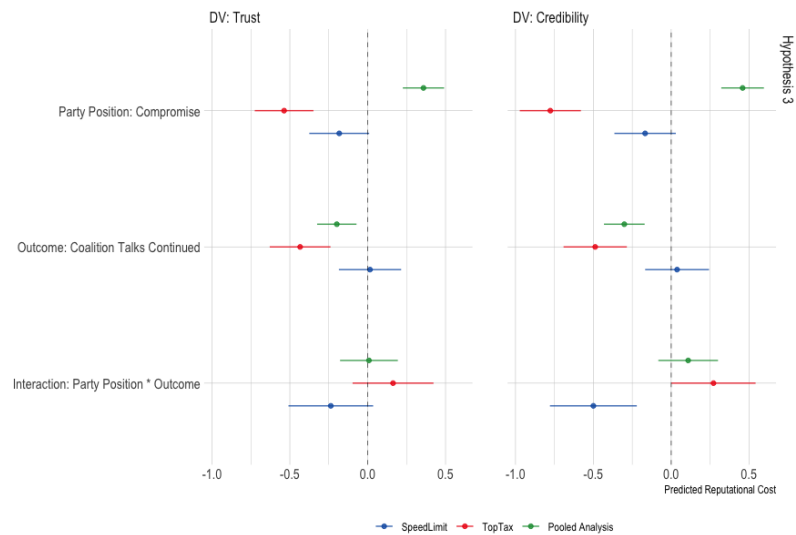
Figure OA.16: Predicted Reputational Cost



Hypothesis 3

Looking at those respondents who know which parties are negotiating for the 2021 coalition, Figure OA.21 shows that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 3) do not change.

Figure OA.17: Predicted Reputational Cost



Hypothesis 4 & 5

Looking at those respondents who know which parties are negotiating for the 2021 coalition, Figures OA.18 and OA.24 show that the main effects shown in the manuscript (Figure 4 and 5) do not

change.

Figure OA.18: Heterogeneous Treatment Effect: Principledness

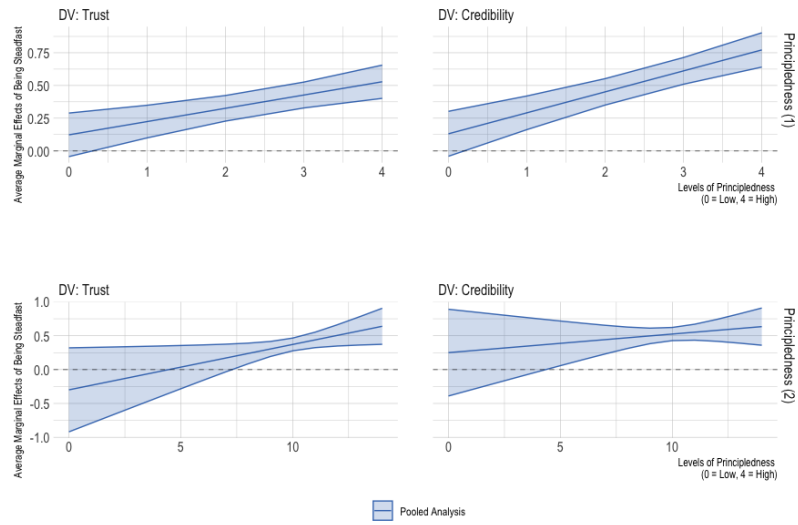
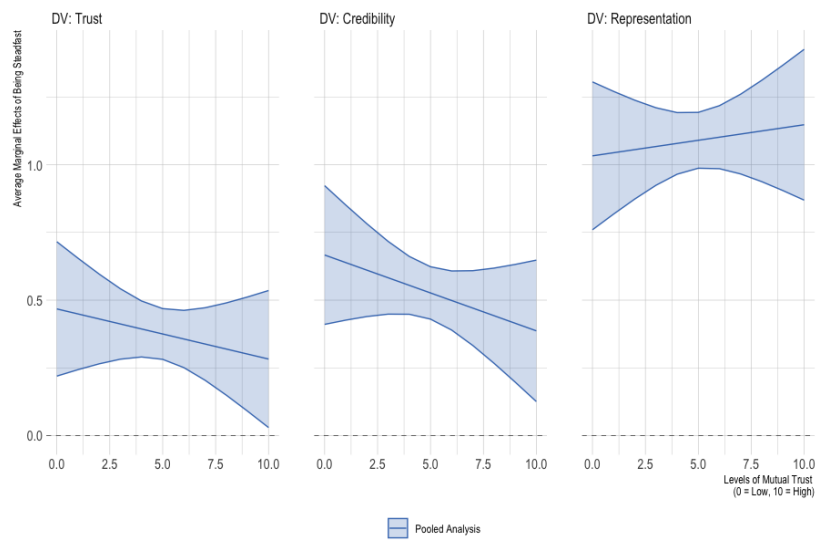
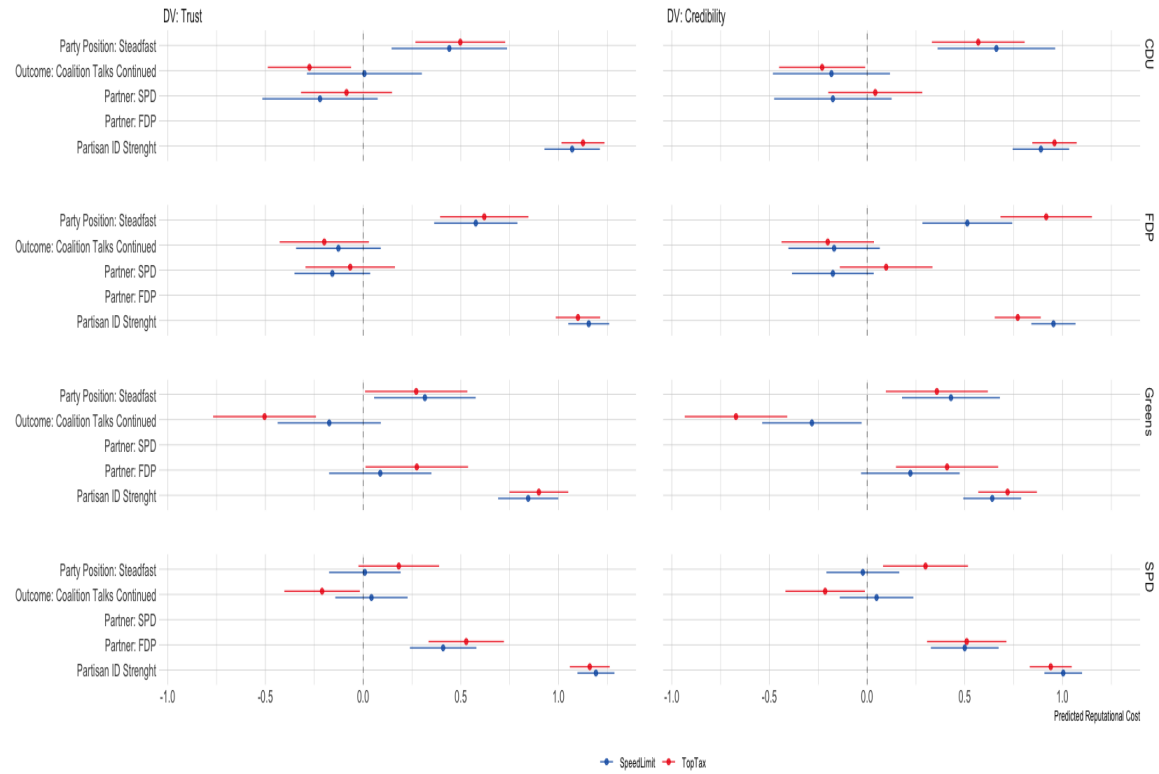


Figure OA.19: Heterogeneous Treatment Effect: Social Trust



Appendix L. Robustness Analyses Experimental Study – Analyses per Party

Figure OA.20: Predicted Reputational Cost



Hypothesis 3

Figure OA.21: Predicted Reputational Cost

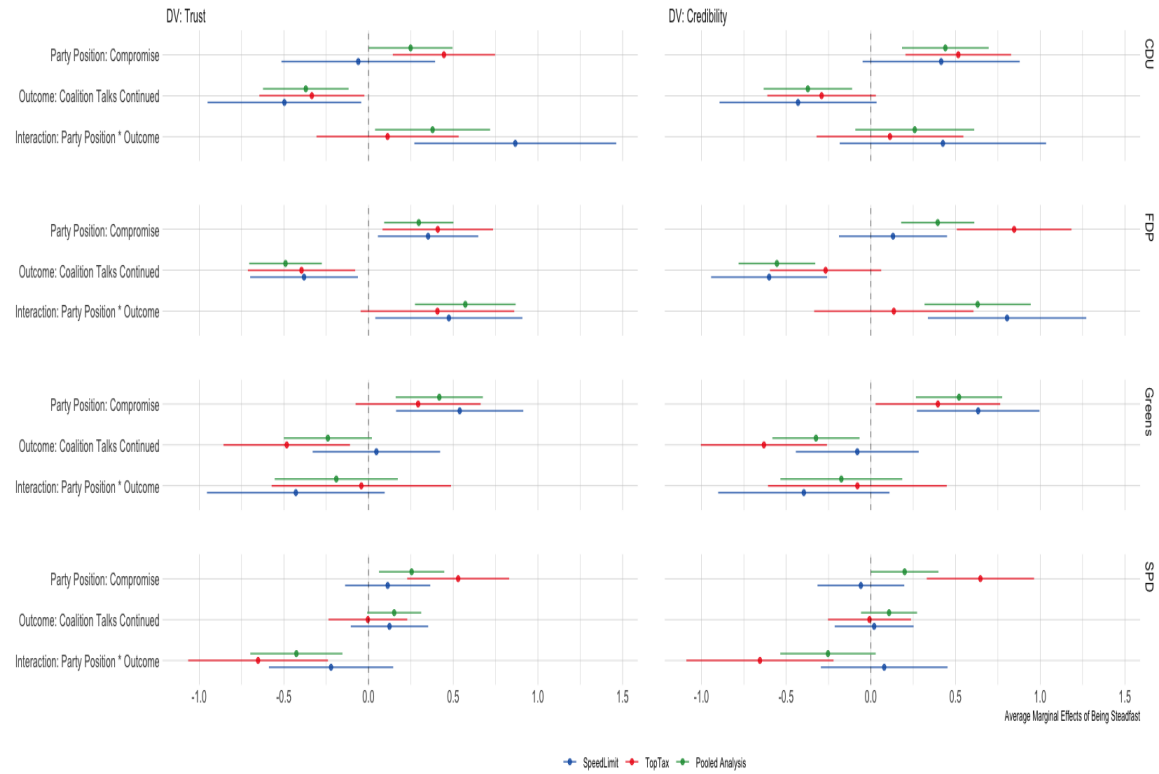


Figure OA.22: Heterogeneous Treatment Effect: Principledness

Principledness (2)

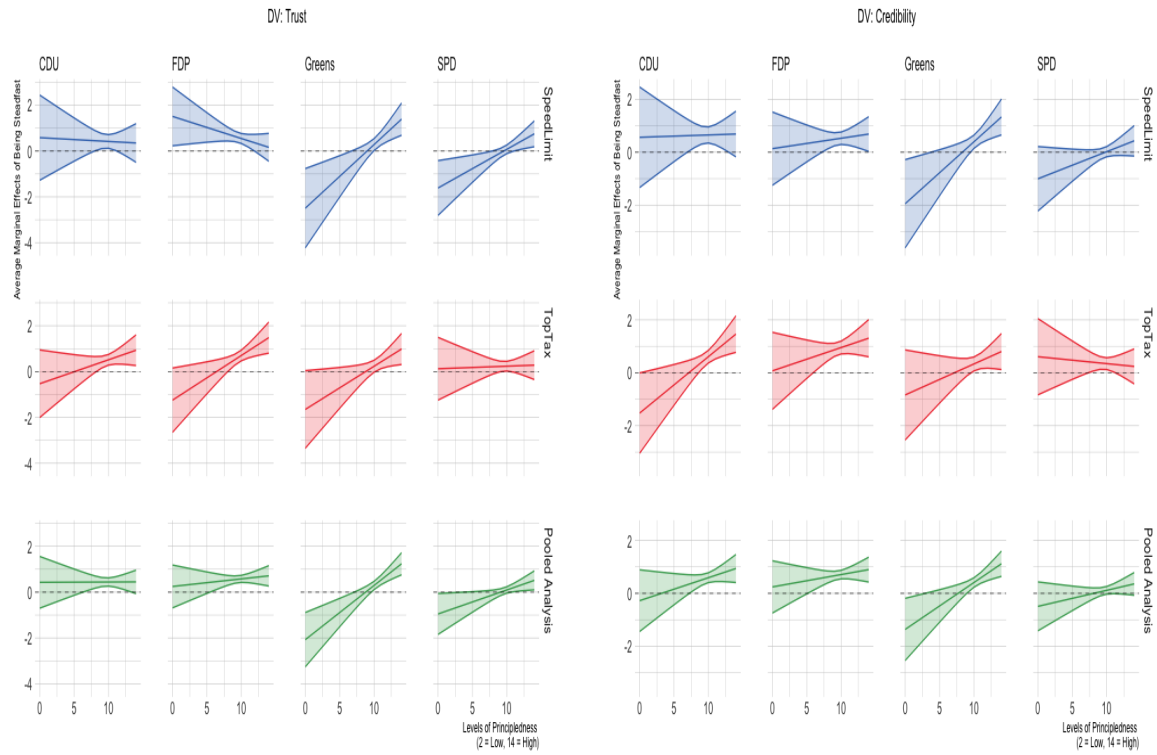


Figure OA.23: Heterogeneous Treatment Effect: Social Trust

Principledness (1)

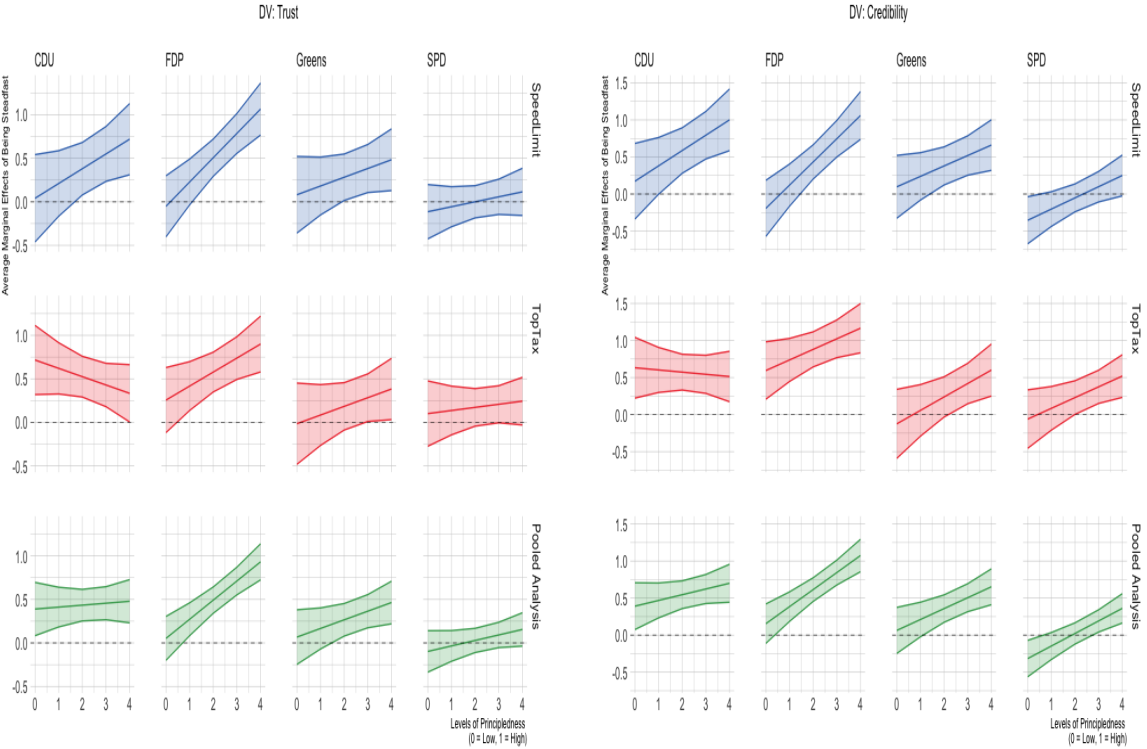
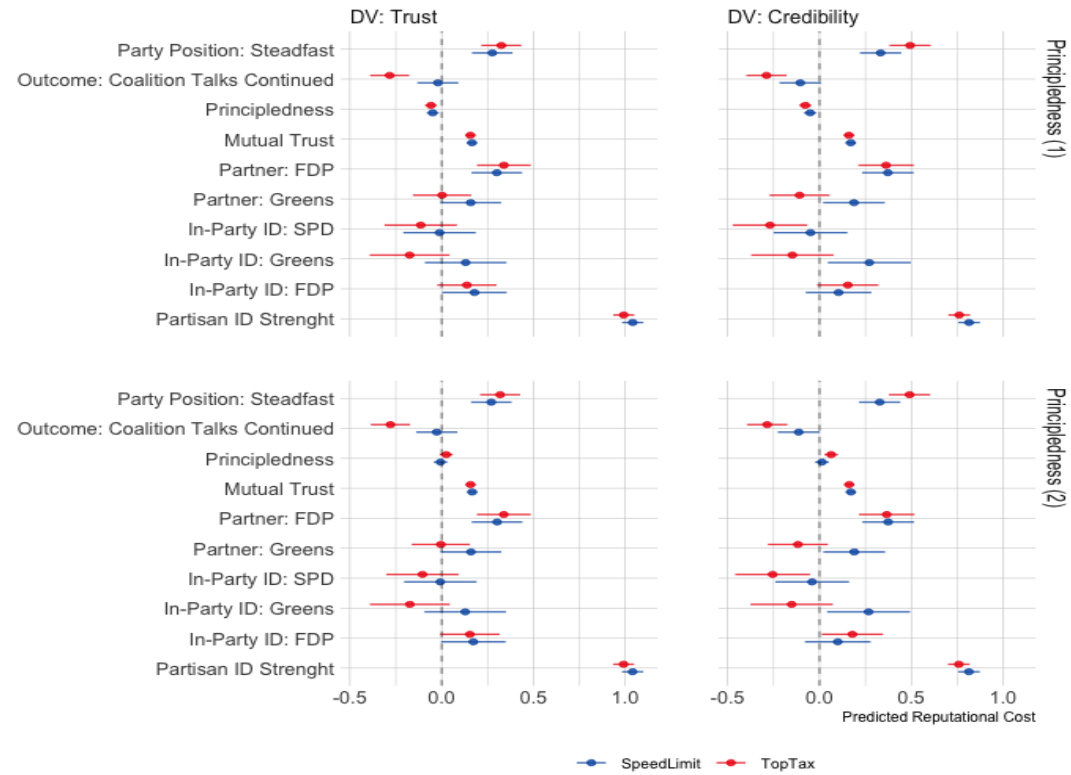


Figure OA.24: Direct Effects of Principledness and Social Trust



Greifer, Noah. 2021. “Cobalt: Covariate Balance Tables and Plots. R Package Version 4.3.1.”
<https://cran.r-project.org/web/packages/cobalt/index.html>.

IRB Statement

Who were the human subject participants in the research? Were vulnerable populations recruited (e.g., children, prisoners, pregnant women, victims of violence, etc.)?

Participants of our experiment (Study 1) were German adults (≥ 18 years). No vulnerable populations were recruited, our goal was to have a random sample of the German population. To ensure that our sample approximates a nationally representative sample, we use quota sampling with quotas for age, gender, and education.

How were the subjects recruited? If you provided compensation or there were other benefits from participation, was the opportunity to participate made available fairly?

Respondents were recruited through survey company Respondi. Respondi collects non-probability samples using non-random opt-in respondents.

How were the subjects compensated, if at all?

Respondi incentivizes respondents by compensating them with 50 points, which is the equivalent to €0.50.

Did subjects participate voluntarily? E.g., did students feel obligated to participate by a professor in a course, or employees by their employer?

The subjects participated voluntarily. After filling in an informed consent, they could additionally stop participating in the survey. The survey was administered online, so there was no control exercised by the researchers.

What are the risks posed to human subjects from participating in the research? It is expected that most research poses minimal risk, meaning there is little chance of upset, distress, physical harm, or discomfort greater than would be encountered in daily life. This minimal risk category includes benign behavioral interventions ("brief in duration, harmless, painless, not physically invasive, not likely to have a significant adverse lasting impact on the subjects, and the investigator has no reason to think the subjects will find the interventions offensive or embarrassing").

There was no risk posed to the human subjects participating in this research.

What are the risks posed to human subjects from accidental disclosure of original data? Is the original data fully anonymous, or, is it possible to identify subjects from the original data? Beware that combinations of multiple demographic categories, IP addresses, IDs from websites such as MTurk, etc. can all be considered identifiable. If the original data is identifiable or potentially identifiable, what risks to subjects would accidental disclosure of the data pose, and what security steps have been taken to limit the risk of accidental disclosure? For example, do the original data contain sensitive personal information (e.g., identity card numbers) or data which could put subjects at risk of embarrassment

or civil or criminal liability?

The collected data is fully anonymous.

Was informed consent obtained from research participants, and if so, how? Note that informed consent is not necessarily required for minimal risk studies if not obtaining consent does not adversely affect the welfare or rights of subjects, if it is impractical to obtain consent, and if debriefing subjects would not be appropriate

Yes, informed consent was obtained at the start of the survey. We asked them the following (translated from German):

Dear Participant,

before you start the survey, we would like to inform you about the survey procedure. Therefore, please read the following text carefully. The purpose of the survey is to find out how citizens in Germany form their opinions about politics. The survey will take about 10 minutes.

Voluntary participation

You can decide to stop participating in this survey at any time. Likewise, you can request that your study data be deleted after the study.

Your privacy is guaranteed

Your personal information will be kept confidential and will not be shared without your explicit consent. This data will only be analyzed by the researchers who collected the data. Research data published in scientific journals is anonymous and cannot be traced back to you. Fully anonymized research data will be made publicly available.

Additional Information

If you have any questions about this study before or after the study, please contact the researchers responsible, [NAME] and [NAME]. E-mail: [EMAIL].

By agreeing to participate in the study and to use the data obtained, you declare that you have read and understood the participant information. Please select the answer that applies to you.

Participants could either choose *I agree to participate in the study and to the use of the data thus obtained* or *I do not agree to participate in the study and to the use of the data thus obtained*. If chosen the latter, the survey ends for them.

Did the research take place in a country which requires government ethics review of human subjects research, and if so was such an approval obtained?

The survey took place in Germany, and the government ethics review of human subjects research of Germany was not required. We did do the ethics review of the home institute of one of authors. Given that there was no risk involved,

this only required a self check.